IELTS SPEAKING VOCABULARY BANK — SIMPLIFIED VERSION

1. What you actually need to memorise

Do **not** memorise fifty alternatives for *good, bad, like,* and *important*.

For your level, prioritise these four things:

Natural collocation

- make a decision
- solve a problem
- gain experience
- spend quality time
- meet a deadline
- take responsibility
- express an opinion
- reach a goal
- keep in touch
- pay attention to detail

Accurate basic grammar

- people **don't**, not *people doesn't*
- they **seem**, not *they seems*
- everyone **wants**
- children **are**
- a person **has**
- if I **had**, I **would**
- if I **were**
- explain something **to someone**
- depend **on**
- interested **in**

Easy linking

- The main reason is that...
- Another reason is...
- For example,...
- At the same time,...
- On the other hand,...
- That being said,...
- As a result,...

- Overall,...

Useful qualification

- It depends on the situation.
- To a certain extent.
- In most cases.
- I wouldn't say this applies to everyone.
- There are obviously some exceptions.
- It largely depends on the individual.

That is far more useful to you than trying to replace every normal verb with a “Band 8 verb.” Your existing bank also correctly identifies grammar, sentence control, self-correction, and natural collocations as your main barriers.

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2. UNIVERSAL PART 1 LANGUAGE

For Part 1, use:

Answer → reason → detail

Useful phrases:

- Yes, definitely.
- Not particularly.
- Quite often.
- Every now and then.
- It depends.
- I tend to...
- I usually prefer...
- I'm quite fond of...
- I'm not particularly interested in...
- The main reason is that...
- What I like most about it is...
- One thing I don't like is...
- For example,...
- Especially when...

You usually **do not need an idiom** in Part 1.

Example

> Do you like taking pictures?

“Yeah, quite often. I usually take pictures when I travel because I like keeping a visual record of the places I've visited. I still have several photos from my trip to Switzerland on my phone.”

That is better for you than trying to force *picturesque, breathtaking, captivating, visually compelling* into three sentences.

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3. UNIVERSAL PART 3 LANGUAGE

Your Part 3 target should normally be:

Position → reason → example → qualification → conclusion

Useful language:

- I think there are several reasons for this.
- One of the main factors is...
- This is particularly important when...
- A good example would be...
- This can lead to...
- The opposite can also be true.
- That doesn't necessarily mean that...
- It depends heavily on...
- From a broader perspective,...
- Overall, I would say...

For comparison questions:

- The main difference is...
- Compared with...
- Whereas...
- By contrast,...
- They tend to...
- Younger people are more likely to...
- Older people may be more inclined to...
- There is some overlap, though.

For advantages/disadvantages:

- One obvious advantage is...
- Another benefit is...
- The main drawback is...
- The trade-off is that...
- The benefits probably outweigh the disadvantages.

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4. WORK, STUDY, JOBS & BUSINESS

This covers your questions about university, workplaces, careers, companies, internships, successful businesses, teamwork and leadership.

Core vocabulary

- work environment
- workplace culture
- career path
- career progression
- professional development
- practical experience
- hands-on experience
- technical skills
- soft skills
- professional qualifications
- heavy workload
- tight deadline
- job security
- job satisfaction
- work-life balance
- salary range
- financial stability
- take responsibility
- work under pressure
- meet deadlines
- gain experience
- build expertise
- apply for a position
- pursue a career
- run a business
- start a business
- be your own boss
- attract customers
- satisfy customer needs
- customer service
- attention to detail
- generate revenue
- cash flow
- market competition
- find a niche

Prefer

“**run a business**”
not *rule a business*

“**work environment**”
not *working environment* every time

“**outdated equipment**”
not *bad hardware*

“**network of contacts**”
not *connections pool*

“**financial pressure**”
not *critical financial conditions*

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5. EDUCATION, TEACHERS & LEARNING

Covers school, teachers, learning new skills, language learning, science, history and educational methods.

- learning environment
- teaching method
- academic performance
- curriculum
- theoretical knowledge
- practical skills
- build a solid foundation
- develop critical thinking
- explain a concept clearly
- provide guidance
- give constructive feedback
- recognise someone's potential
- keep students engaged
- learning process
- learning curve
- reliable source
- credible information
- deepen my understanding
- acquire knowledge
- practise consistently
- learn through experience
- conversation practice
- language exposure
- native speakers
- become fluent
- expand my vocabulary
- improve grammatical accuracy

Very useful for language questions

- regular exposure to the language
- put knowledge into practice
- communicate naturally
- overcome the fear of speaking
- receive immediate feedback
- learn at your own pace
- practise in a group
- develop speaking confidence

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6. TECHNOLOGY, AI, APPS & WEBSITES

This needs a much larger place in your bank because it appears repeatedly in your workbook and it is a topic you naturally speak about well.

- artificial intelligence
- AI-powered tool
- mobile application
- software platform
- user interface
- user experience
- online service
- digital tool
- technological development
- technical issue
- software engineer
- deploy a model
- write code
- debug an issue
- automate a task
- streamline a process
- access information
- process information
- protect personal data
- data privacy
- cybersecurity
- reliable internet connection
- online platform
- digital communication
- recommendation system
- personalised content
- depend on technology
- rely too heavily on technology

Natural phrases

- make my work more efficient
- save a considerable amount of time
- access it from almost anywhere
- use it on a daily basis
- encounter a technical problem
- solve an issue
- improve the user experience
- reduce repetitive work
- verify the information
- use AI as a supporting tool

Avoid trying to sound technical simply because the topic is technology.

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7. SOCIAL MEDIA, NEWS, MESSAGES & ADVERTISING

- social media platform
- messaging app
- online community
- short-form content
- digital content
- news source
- reliable source
- misleading information
- misinformation
- online advertising
- targeted advertising
- celebrity endorsement
- influence consumer behaviour
- catch someone's attention
- scroll through social media
- keep up with friends
- keep up with the news
- share a post
- upload content
- go viral
- spend too much time scrolling
- limit screen time
- verify information
- form an opinion
- communicate instantly

Advertising

- attract attention
- build brand awareness
- influence purchasing decisions
- promote a product
- target a particular audience
- informed consumer
- compare different options
- be influenced by advertising
- be swayed by an advertisement

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8. TV, FILMS, VIDEOS & ENTERTAINMENT

- streaming platform
- traditional television
- television schedule
- watch on demand
- binge-watch a series
- documentary
- drama series
- talk show
- sports broadcast
- short-form video
- compelling story
- plot
- character development
- visual effects
- soundtrack
- thought-provoking
- entertaining
- emotionally engaging
- leave a lasting impression
- appeal to a wide audience
- educational content
- age-appropriate content
- inappropriate content
- parental controls
- limit screen time

Technology + television

- watch content on demand
- pause and rewind
- stream across different devices
- personalised recommendations
- no longer depend on a fixed schedule

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9. BOOKS, STORIES & READING

- novel
- non-fiction book
- technical book
- storyline
- main character
- plot
- author
- chapter
- engaging
- thought-provoking
- informative
- practical
- easy to follow
- difficult concept
- useful insight
- broaden my horizons
- deepen my understanding
- read regularly
- skim through
- read in detail
- recommend a book
- have an impact on me

For your technical-book answers:

- practical application
- industry knowledge
- real-world example
- technical concept
- relevant to my work
- apply what I learned

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10. ART, DRAWING, MUSEUMS & ARCHITECTURE

- artwork
- painting
- exhibition
- art gallery
- museum
- historical artefact
- cultural heritage
- artistic expression
- visual style
- modern art
- traditional art
- realistic painting
- abstract art
- architectural style
- historic building
- modern skyscraper
- landmark
- observation deck
- striking design
- glass facade
- intricate details
- architectural heritage
- preserve a building
- restore a building
- stand out
- have historical significance
- admire the design
- appreciate the craftsmanship

Buildings

- located in the heart of...
- seven storeys high
- overlook the city
- offer panoramic views
- serve as a landmark
- believed to have served as a watchtower
- well-preserved
- poorly maintained
- renovated
- modern infrastructure

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11. HOME, HOMETOWN, CITIES & COMMUNITY

- hometown
- neighbourhood
- residential area
- city centre
- suburban area
- rural area
- urban area
- apartment block
- residential building
- local community
- public facilities
- public transport
- infrastructure
- convenient location
- close to shops and transport
- lively atmosphere
- peaceful neighbourhood
- sense of belonging
- community spirit
- local resident
- supportive neighbour
- close-knit community

City vs countryside

- fast-paced lifestyle
- slower pace of life
- access to services
- employment opportunities
- public transport network
- green spaces
- less traffic
- cleaner air
- more privacy
- fewer entertainment options

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12. SCENERY, VIEWS & NATURE

Use **scenery** as an uncountable noun most of the time:

- beautiful scenery
- stunning view
- scenic landscape
- mountain scenery
- urban skyline
- cityscape
- coastline
- lake
- river
- mountain range
- surrounding countryside
- natural landscape
- panoramic view
- peaceful surroundings
- picturesque area
- take pictures of the scenery
- capture the view
- enjoy the scenery
- surrounded by mountains
- overlook the city
- tied to my childhood memories

Avoid

“different sceneries” → usually **different landscapes / different views**

“nature, lands, sky” → **natural landscapes and scenery**

“helds a special memory” → **holds a special memory / reminds me of the trip**

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13. PARKS, WALKING, RIVERS & ENVIRONMENT

- public park
- green space
- recreational area
- walking path
- riverside
- lakeside
- natural environment
- fresh air
- scenic surroundings
- escape the city
- clear my head

- go for a walk
- stay physically active
- reconnect with nature
- protect the environment
- reduce pollution
- preserve natural habitats
- environmental protection
- waste management
- littering
- renewable energy
- hydroelectric power
- drinking water
- generate electricity

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14. TRAVEL, HOLIDAYS & TRANSPORT

- travel abroad
- travel domestically
- tourist destination
- accommodation
- travel itinerary
- local transport
- public transport
- flight
- airport transfer
- travel documents
- visa requirements
- book accommodation
- make a reservation
- plan ahead
- travel spontaneously
- explore a city
- visit a landmark
- cultural experience
- tourist attraction
- peak season
- travel on a budget

Cars and traffic

- traffic jam
- traffic congestion
- rush hour
- stuck in traffic

- at a standstill
- commute to work
- road infrastructure
- speed limit
- parking regulations
- public transport network
- fuel-efficient car
- electric vehicle
- sports car
- sleek design

Natural Part 1 car language

- I'm not too fussed about the colour.
- I'd probably go with black.
- I'm drawn to sports cars.
- I like the way they look.
- They have a sleek design.

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15. FOOD, COOKING & RESTAURANTS

This should be a major section because it appears repeatedly.

- traditional dish
- local cuisine
- home-cooked meal
- special occasion
- family gathering
- festive meal
- lamb
- grilled meat
- grilled over charcoal
- kebab
- plov
- side dish
- dessert
- traditional sweets
- spicy
- rich flavour
- freshly prepared
- filling
- share a meal
- bring the family together
- eat together

- enjoy a special meal
- order food
- eat out
- cook from scratch
- prepare a meal
- convenient alternative
- takeaway
- food delivery

Useful ideas

Why spend more on special food?

- make the occasion memorable
- show hospitality
- maintain a family tradition
- celebrate together
- create a festive atmosphere

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16. SHOPPING, MONEY & CONSUMER LIFE

- shopping mall
- retail store
- online shopping
- shop around
- compare prices
- value for money
- affordable
- overpriced
- reasonable price
- expensive purchase
- spend more than expected
- stick to a budget
- save money
- impulse purchase
- purchasing decision
- brand
- customer
- product quality
- customer service
- return a product
- make a purchase

- save up for something

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17. CLOTHES, WATCHES, GIFTS, KEYS & PERSONAL OBJECTS

Clothes

- casual clothes
- smart-casual style
- formal wear
- formal suit
- hoodie
- sweatshirt
- plain T-shirt
- printed T-shirt
- match an outfit
- look neat
- look presentable
- comfortable to wear
- suit my style
- dress more formally
- neutral colours
- darker shades

Correct:

- **plain T-shirt**, not *clear T-shirt*
- **formal suit**, not *official costume*
- **neater**, not *more neater*

Watches

- mechanical watch
- smartwatch
- leather strap
- watch face / dial
- status symbol
- sentimental value
- practical accessory

Gifts

- thoughtful gift

- meaningful present
- sentimental value
- give someone a present
- receive a gift

Keys

- keychain
- house key
- misplace my keys
- lose my keys
- retrace my steps
- carry only the essentials

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18. SPORTS, TEAMS & COMPETITION

- team sport
- individual sport
- competitive sport
- sports event
- live match
- stadium
- supporter
- crowd
- atmosphere
- professional athlete
- coach
- teammate
- training session
- teamwork
- communication
- team spirit
- individual performance
- compete against
- take part in
- play basketball
- watch a match live
- follow a team
- improve fitness
- stay in shape

Stadium vs home

- live atmosphere

- sense of excitement
- crowd energy
- camera angles
- instant replays
- commentary
- comfort and convenience

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19. FITNESS, HEALTH & RELAXATION

- exercise regularly
- stay physically active
- maintain an active lifestyle
- workout routine
- cardiovascular health
- physical fitness
- mental well-being
- relieve stress
- clear my mind
- unwind after work
- recharge
- get enough sleep
- sedentary lifestyle
- physical exhaustion
- mental fatigue
- switch off mentally
- work-life balance

For Part 3:

- physical and mental benefits
- improve concentration
- reduce stress
- improve sleep quality
- develop a healthy routine

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20. MEDICINE & HEALTHCARE

- medical field
- healthcare sector
- healthcare professional
- doctor

- surgeon
- patient
- patient care
- treatment
- diagnosis
- medical research
- perform surgery
- treat patients
- diagnose a condition
- develop a treatment
- clinical experience
- medical expertise
- demanding career
- life-saving work
- improve quality of life

Correct:

treat cancer / cure cancer
not *treat the cancer* in a general statement.

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21. FAMILY, CHILDREN, FRIENDSHIP & HELPING OTHERS

- close friend
- childhood friend
- family member
- close relative
- supportive relationship
- emotional support
- practical support
- give advice
- ask for advice
- offer guidance
- lend a helping hand
- rely on someone
- trust someone
- keep in touch
- spend quality time
- share experiences
- build confidence
- encourage someone
- help someone solve a problem

Children

- upbringing
- parental guidance
- set boundaries
- set a good example
- teach responsibility
- household chores
- age-appropriate task
- become independent
- develop good habits
- reward positive behaviour
- reasonable consequence

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22. RULES, LAWS & PUNISHMENT

- obey the rules
- follow the law
- break a rule
- break the law
- legal consequences
- fine
- punishment
- law enforcement
- traffic regulations
- parking rules
- speed limits
- public safety
- school rules
- workplace rules
- confidentiality
- data protection
- apply rules consistently
- enforce the law
- explain why a rule exists
- set clear boundaries

Particularly useful

- Rules make behaviour more predictable.
- They exist mainly to protect people.
- Parents should explain the reason behind a rule.
- Consequences should be consistent.
- Laws should be applied fairly.

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23. GOALS, AMBITION, SUCCESS & DECISIONS

- set a goal
- achieve a goal
- work towards a goal
- long-term goal
- short-term objective
- realistic target
- sense of direction
- stay motivated
- measure progress
- fulfil an ambition
- career ambition
- reach my full potential
- make a decision
- weigh the pros and cons
- consider the risks
- think through possible outcomes
- take responsibility for a decision
- make an informed decision
- change my mind
- reconsider my opinion

Excellent Part 3 conclusion

“Ultimately, people have to weigh their goals and values against the risks involved.”

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24. PLANNING, ORGANISATION & TIDINESS

- plan ahead
- make plans in advance
- change plans
- rearrange my schedule
- cancel at the last minute
- organise my time
- keep track of
- calendar app

- reminder
- set priorities
- manage my time
- stay organised
- keep things tidy
- keep my desk clear
- put things back in their place
- clean as I go
- clutter
- messy
- well-organised

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25. IMAGINATION, CREATIVITY & OPINIONS

Important after today's mock.

- imagination
- imaginative
- creative thinking
- come up with an idea
- develop a new approach
- solve a problem creatively
- think outside the box
- look at a problem from another angle
- build on existing knowledge
- develop a new solution
- experiment with different approaches
- express an idea
- form an opinion
- defend a position
- support an argument
- reconsider a view
- keep an open mind

Scientists

Use:

“Scientists need imagination to **build on existing knowledge and develop new solutions**.”

Not:

“Scientists have to make up something.”

Creative professions

- filmmaker
- graphic designer
- artist
- architect
- marketing professional
- writer
- teacher
- researcher
- engineer

And avoid saying engineers or scientists have less imagination. A better distinction is:

“Different professions **use imagination in different ways**.”

That is much safer and more sophisticated.

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26. HISTORY, CULTURE & OLD THINGS

- historical event
- historical period
- cultural heritage
- historical significance
- historic building
- historical figure
- museum
- artefact
- preserve the past
- learn from history
- understand the causes and consequences
- cultural identity
- national tradition
- preserve a building
- restore an old building
- Soviet-era apartment block
- functional infrastructure

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27. ANIMALS, PETS & PLANTS

- wild animal

- domestic animal
- pet
- animal welfare
- animal handler
- natural habitat
- endangered species
- responsible pet ownership
- look after a pet
- care for an animal
- companionship
- grow plants
- maintain a garden
- gardening
- look after plants
- green space

For the monkey example you practised:

- animal handler
- offer tourists photo opportunities
- pose for photos
- tourist attraction
- unsettling
- potentially unsafe

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28. DAILY ROUTINES, CHILDHOOD & FREE TIME

- daily routine
- morning routine
- evening routine
- spare time
- free time
- day off
- childhood memory
- childhood hobby
- spend time with friends
- relax at home
- unwind after work
- meet up with friends
- play basketball
- build Lego sets
- develop a hobby

- keep a hobby from childhood
- make time for
- break the routine

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29. DREAMS — SLEEP

Keep this section very simple.

- remember a dream
- forget a dream
- fade within minutes
- vivid dream
- strange dream
- recurring dream
- wake up
- make a quick note
- recall the details
- brain processing information
- nothing mystical

A strong answer:

> “I rarely remember my dreams because they tend to fade within minutes. If I make a quick note as soon as I wake up, I'm much more likely to recall the details later.”

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30. UNIVERSAL PART 2 FRAMEWORKS

This is more valuable than making 75 separate vocabulary sections.

A. Describe a person

Use:

Who → relationship → what happened / what they do → qualities → why they matter

- I've known him for...
- We first met...
- What stands out about him is...
- What I admire most is...
- He helped me...

- He encouraged me to...
- He made me realise...
- I felt relieved / grateful / proud.

B. Describe a place/building

Identify → location → appearance → what you can do there → personal reason

- located in the heart of...
- surrounded by...
- known for...
- what stands out is...
- I'd particularly like to...
- I've never had the chance to...
- it would be memorable because...

C. Describe an event/experience

When → situation → problem/action → result → reflection

- It happened...
- At first,...
- The main problem was...
- I decided to...
- Eventually,...
- Looking back,...
- What I learned from the experience was...

D. Describe an object/app/technology

What → when you got/started using it → functions → example → why important

- I use it on a daily basis.
- I mainly rely on it for...
- What makes it particularly useful is...
- One good example is...
- I would struggle without it because...

E. Describe a film/book/story

Identify → plot/topic → strongest feature → reaction → recommendation

- It is mainly about...
- What I found particularly engaging was...
- It made me think about...
- It left a lasting impression on me.

- I would recommend it because...

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31. YOUR PERSONAL “DO NOT SAY” LIST

This is probably the **most valuable page for you**.

Instead of:

- more easier
  → **easier**
- more healthier
  → **healthier**
- me and my friends
  → **my friends and I**
- explain me
  → **explain to me**
- suggest someone to do
  → **suggest that someone do / encourage someone to do**
- people doesn't
  → **people don't**
- they seems
  → **they seem**
- everyone choose
  → **everyone chooses**
- advices
  → **advice**
- an access
  → **access**
- have a breakfast
  → **have breakfast**
- a plenty of
  → **plenty of**
- working place
  → **workplace**
- working environment
  → **work environment** usually
- do sports
  → **exercise / play sports**
- have a walk
  → **go for a walk**
- have a quality time
  → **spend quality time**

- financial caution
  → **financial security / financial stability**
- rule a business
  → **run a business**
- connections pool
  → **network of contacts**
- very attractable
  → **very attractive**
- most favorable dish
  → **favourite dish**
- official costume
  → **formal suit**
- clear T-shirt
  → **plain T-shirt**
- different sceneries
  → **different views / landscapes / beautiful scenery**
- deeply tightened to
  → **closely tied to / closely connected to**
- make up a new approach
  → **develop / come up with a new approach**
- better a problem
  → **solve / tackle a problem**
- until these days
  → **so far / yet**
- if cancer would be treated
  → **if cancer were cured**
- build on existing ways
  → **build on existing knowledge**
- it helds a memory
  → **it holds a special memory / it reminds me of...**
- less tend to
  → **are less likely to**
- more neater
  → **neater**
- in live
  → **live / in person**
- in the university
  → usually **at university**
- go to the university
  → usually **go to university / attend university**